What my agents may do alone, and what waits for me

Ben Wagner, Customermates. The rules I run our own go-to-market on, with AI agents working inside our CRM.

1. Give every agent its own user

- One user per agent, never a shared login. Every change then has one name on it.
- Give that user a narrow role: the inbox agent can file mail, but cannot delete a contact or change who sees what.
- Keep one admin for yourself. Agents never get admin.

2. Split by effect, not by difficulty

Runs alone:

- Reading records, mail and the knowledge base
- Filing conversations
- Updating records inside the agent's role (stage, next step, notes)
- Drafting replies and posts

Waits for a person:

- Sending anything to a client or prospect
- Publishing anything public
- Spending money
- Deleting records or changing access

A hard research task can run all night if it ends in a draft. A two-line email still waits, because it leaves the building.

3. Make the approval worth something

- Keep the draft next to the client record, so you see who it is for before you read it.
- Read before you click. An approval you did not read is a rubber stamp.
- Check the activity log once a week: who changed what, under which agent's name.

4. Know what this does not cover

- Token budgets and retry limits belong in the agent's runtime. Cap them there.
- A rule in a prompt is guidance. Roles and approvals in the system are the real limit.

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